

# Client Test Approach

CSD European Offering –  
General approach for market participants

VERSION 24.0



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# 1. Purpose & objectives of testing

## 1.1 Context

The European Offering is Euronext's initiative to extend its post-trade services beyond domestic markets, enabling issuers and market participants to access a harmonized, pan-European CSD offering. This initiative introduces new operational, legal, and technical capabilities that support cross-border issuance, settlement, and related post-trade services, while aligning with applicable market practices and regulatory requirements.

As part of this evolution, changes are introduced across systems, processes, and participant interactions. A structured and coordinated testing approach is therefore required to ensure that these changes can be adopted by market participants in a controlled manner, without disruption to live operations.

## 1.2 Purpose of this document

This document defines the high-level approach under which the European Offering will be tested and validated with clients and market participants prior to go-live across the value-chain. Its purpose is to ensure that the set of changes delivered as part of the European Offering is implemented consistently, operates as intended, and can be safely deployed into production.

**In addition to this document, specific test documentation will be published by Euronext Markets, Euronext Clearing, and Euronext Securities, applicable specifically to each entity's relevant clients and market participants as the scope of testing differs for the various entities. You can find relevant links to this information in this document.**

## 1.3 Objectives of testing

The objectives of testing under this guideline are to:

- Confirm that the final solutions are fully implemented and meets the agreed business requirements, applicable market practices, and client expectations.
- Validate that end-to-end processes operate in a stable, correct, and robust manner across all relevant scenarios.
- Ensure that the delivered solution produces the expected operational and business benefits for all impacted participants.
- Build a high level of confidence among users and customers in the quality of the solution and in the rigor of the applied testing and control approach.
- Support client readiness by providing sufficient transparency, validation opportunities, and assurance ahead of go-live.

## 2. Target audience

This high-level test approach document is intended for all market participants involved in, or impacted by, the European Offering. It provides a common reference for understanding the objectives, scope, and organization of testing activities ahead of go-live.

This document applies to all actors participating in the European Offering ecosystem. Differences in testing scope, obligations, and expectations are described on a high-level in this document and further detailed in the test documentation published by Euronext Markets, Euronext Clearing, and Euronext Securities, respectively.

The key stakeholders of this document include the following participant categories:

- Trading Members
- Euronext Trading Venues
- Clearing Members
- Central Counterparties (CCPs), including:
  - Euronext Clearing
  - Preferred CCPs
- Settlement Agents
- Central Securities Depositories (CSDs), including:
  - Euronext Securities
  - Alternative CSDs
- Custodians
- Issuing Agents, Issuers, and Registrars

Each participant category mentioned above is expected to use this document, together with the entity specific test documentation, as references to understand how testing is structured, what is expected from them, and how readiness for the European Offering will be assessed, in line with their specific role and services used.

### **Note for Issuing Agents and Issuers**

Due to the diversity of service configurations, timelines, and onboarding models applicable to these stakeholders, testing with Issuing Agents and Issuers is handled on a case-by-case basis. Issuing Agents and Issuers wishing to test services offered by Euronext Securities are requested to contact Euronext Securities ([CSD.onboarding@euronext.com](mailto:CSD.onboarding@euronext.com)) to initiate tailored onboarding and testing activities aligned with the specific needs of each Issuing Agent or Issuer.

## 3. Scope of testing

The scope of testing for the European Offering covers the key functional and operational changes introduced across the post-trade value chain. Testing is designed to validate that these changes operate correctly on a standalone basis and, where relevant, end-to-end across multiple actors. The overall scope includes services covering issuance, trading, clearing, settlement, safekeeping, corporate actions, and fiscal services. Testing focuses on areas where new services are introduced, or interfaces and message flows are materially impacted.

Testing scope varies depending on the type of market participant and the services they use. To support this, a service-by-participant matrix for Euronext clients is provided below, indicating the expected level of testing per combination. For clients of Euronext Markets (Trading Members) and Euronext Clearing (Clearing Members),

front-to-back testing are applicable. For clients of Euronext Securities (Settlement Agents and Custodians), testing includes a greater set of services in addition to front-to-back. Where relevant, clients are expected to align testing needs with their providers.

The matrix should be read as a guide to support planning and coordination of testing activities and to ensure consistent expectations across participant categories.

| Services                                                        | Trading Member               | Clearing Member              | Settlement Agent | Custodian        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------|------------------|
| <b>Front-to-back testing</b>                                    | <b>Mandatory<sup>1</sup></b> | <b>Mandatory<sup>2</sup></b> | <b>Mandatory</b> | <b>Mandatory</b> |
| Registered Shares and Information on Registered Investors (IRI) | N/A                          | N/A                          | Conditional      | Conditional      |
| Stamp Duty                                                      | N/A                          | N/A                          | Conditional      | Conditional      |
| Post Trade Confirmation System (PTCS)                           | Conditional                  | N/A                          | Conditional      | Conditional      |
| Portfolio Migration and Position Transfer                       | N/A                          | N/A                          | Conditional      | Conditional      |
| Fiscal Services (Tax)                                           | N/A                          | N/A                          | Recommended      | Recommended      |
| Corporate Events                                                | N/A                          | N/A                          | Recommended      | Recommended      |
| General Meetings and Proxy Voting                               | N/A                          | N/A                          | Recommended      | Recommended      |

The following definitions apply:

<sup>1</sup> It is mandatory for Trading Members changing their current CSD to complete the front-to-back testing in preparation for the go-live. Trading Members not changing their current CSD are recommended to test, keeping in mind that they should undertake the risk of facing issues at the go-live in case they decide not to perform any testing.

<sup>2</sup> It is mandatory for Clearing Members to test all relevant setups applicable to themselves and their respective clients. Euronext Clearing provides a suggested list of applicable tests. By completing the mandatory self-certification form, Clearing Members will attest that they have performed all relevant tests for themselves and their clients to ensure go-live readiness.

**Mandatory to Test**

Testing is mandatory. Participants must execute the relevant tests and provide a formal sign-off document as evidence of successful testing and operational readiness.

**Recommended to Test**

Testing is not mandatory but is strongly advised for participants seeking to reduce operational risk or gain confidence in using the new service. No formal sign-off is required.

**Conditional to Test**

Testing is mandatory only for participants of Euronext Securities who are impacted by the change or who have explicitly requested the service.

These areas broadly define the functional perimeter of the testing activities. Detailed test scenarios per service and per client typology are defined separately and published by each Euronext entity.

## 4. Testing phases & milestones

Testing for the European Offering is structured into two main phases: Test Preparation and Test Execution. This phased approach ensures that all prerequisites are in place before testing starts and that execution is conducted in a controlled, transparent, and risk-focused manner. Each phase includes clearly defined responsibilities for Euronext and for market participants, with timelines and milestones communicated in advance.

### 4.1 Test preparation phase

The test preparation phase focuses on establishing the technical, operational, and organizational readiness required to start testing efficiently and without delay.

**What clients can expect from Euronext ahead of testing**

Ahead of the testing start, the respective Euronext entity will ensure that the following elements are in place:

- Detailed test documentation for all relevant services in scope of testing
- Test environments ready and available, including:
  - Euronext Markets: Next EUA
  - Euronext Clearing: EUA
  - Euronext Securities: EUA (connected to T2S UTEST)
- Installation of the relevant services and functionalities in the test environments
- Test data availability, including a defined list of ISINs and reference data to be used during testing
- Upload of balance of selected ISIN in scope into omnibus account of clients to facilitate test scenario
- Availability of relevant connectivity
- Processes in place for:
  - Test progress dashboard
  - Defect logging and follow-up
  - Status reporting
  - Structured communication set-up (e.g., named contacts, coordination meetings, standard reporting and support channels)

### Client preparation responsibilities

Clients are expected to complete the necessary preparation activities applicable to them, as defined by the detailed client test documentation provided by Euronext, ahead of test execution phase. Timely completion of these actions is critical to ensure that testing can start as planned. Please refer to client test documentation published by the relevant Euronext entity for more information about required client preparation.

## 4.2 Test execution phase

The test execution phase covers the execution of test scenarios as defined in the detailed client test documentation published by each Euronext entity. During this phase clients execute the defined test scenarios, defects are logged and resolved by Euronext, and regular status updates/coordination meetings are held to monitor progress and address issues.

The test execution phase will be run by each individual Euronext entity for the relevant test scope as previously defined in this document. For more information regarding test execution per Euronext entity, please refer to the client test documentation published by the relevant Euronext entity.

## 4.3 Testing timeline and milestones

Testing is planned and executed according to defined timelines per service according to the overview below. These timelines reflect service readiness, dependencies, and sequencing across the post-trade value chain. Please remember that for Trading Members<sup>3</sup> and Clearing Members, only front-to-back is relevant for testing (**dark blue**), while the remaining services (**light blue**) are applicable for testing for clients of Euronext Securities.

| Services                                    | Feb | Mar                                                           | Apr | May                                                         | Jun                                                          | Jul | Aug |
|---------------------------------------------|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|
| Front-to-back testing                       |     | Test execution: March 5 <sup>th</sup> – July 31 <sup>st</sup> |     |                                                             |                                                              |     |     |
| ISO20022 Settlement Messages via MQ channel |     |                                                               |     |                                                             | Test execution: June 1 <sup>st</sup> – July 31 <sup>st</sup> |     |     |
| Portfolio Migration and Position Transfer   |     | Test execution: March 5 <sup>th</sup> – July 31 <sup>st</sup> |     |                                                             |                                                              |     |     |
| Corporate Events                            |     |                                                               |     | Test execution: May 4 <sup>th</sup> – July 31 <sup>st</sup> |                                                              |     |     |
| General Meetings and Proxy Voting           |     |                                                               |     | Test execution: May 4 <sup>th</sup> – July 31 <sup>st</sup> |                                                              |     |     |

<sup>3</sup> Exception for Trading Members subscribing to Post Trade Confirmation System from Euronext Securities.

| Services                                                                                              | Feb | Mar                                                           | Apr | May                                                            | Jun                                                             | Jul | Aug |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|
| Fiscal Services (Tax)                                                                                 |     |                                                               |     | Test execution<br>May 4 <sup>th</sup> – July 31 <sup>s</sup>   |                                                                 |     |     |
| Post Trade Confirmation System (PTCS)                                                                 |     | Test execution: March 5 <sup>th</sup> – July 31 <sup>st</sup> |     |                                                                |                                                                 |     |     |
| Registered Shares and Information on Registered Investors (IRI) – Euronext Securities as Investor CSD |     |                                                               |     | Test execution:<br>May 4 <sup>th</sup> – July 31 <sup>st</sup> |                                                                 |     |     |
| Registered Shares and Information on Registered Investors (IRI) – Euronext Securities as Issuer CSD   |     |                                                               |     |                                                                | Test execution:<br>June 1 <sup>st</sup> – July 31 <sup>st</sup> |     |     |
| Stamp Duty                                                                                            |     |                                                               |     | Test execution:<br>May 4 <sup>th</sup> – July 31 <sup>st</sup> |                                                                 |     |     |

#### Key milestones to consider are:

- Test window open: March 5<sup>th</sup>, 2026
- Recommended deadline for Clearing Members to submit their Settlement Choice Account Structure Configuration Form for testing (EUA) purposes to Euronext Clearing: April 1<sup>st</sup>, 2026.
  - This recommended deadline is intended to support effective planning and the timely execution of the testing phase. Submissions received after this date will be handled on a best-efforts basis only and may result in limitations to testing scope, sequencing, or scheduling.
  - Clearing Members and Trading Members are expected to coordinate and conclude their EUA account structure for testing purposes by this date based on the designated CSD
- Deadline for Clearing Members to submit their Settlement Choice Account Structure Configuration Form for Production (PROD) purposes to Euronext Clearing and related contractual documents: June 1<sup>st</sup>, 2026
- Deadline for Trading Members to submit the form designating Alternative CSD (if relevant): June 1<sup>st</sup>, 2026
  - Please note that it is strongly recommended to start testing before this deadline.
- Readiness sign-off: July 31<sup>st</sup>, 2026
- Change of Place of Settlement go-live: September 21<sup>st</sup>, 2026
  - Contingency date for change of Place of Settlement go-live: October 12<sup>th</sup>, 2026

The overview above provides an overview of the planned testing windows and key milestones. In case of any updates, this will be communicated through the established testing communication channels.

## 5. Detailed test documentation

To support structured and consistent testing, each Euronext entity will publish relevant client test documentation and/or communication specifically for their clients and services. The client test documentation includes will typically include:

- Guide to support test execution
- Test scenarios and test sets
- Test data and reference information to be used across test environments, where applicable
- Relevant readiness and sign-off forms to be completed, where applicable

The detailed client test documentation from each Euronext entity can be found by following the links below:

- Euronext Markets: [Connect - Euronext Securities European Offering](#)
- Euronext Clearing: [Connect - European Offering / Choice of CSD](#)
- Euronext Securities: [European Offering Documentation](#)

The test documentation may be updated during the testing lifecycle to reflect clarifications or refinements to existing scenarios, defect-driven adjustments requiring re-testing, and/or alignment with finalized service configurations. Any material updates to the catalogue will be communicated to participants through the established testing communication channels.

## 6. Client support model

The client support model for the European Offering is designed to provide clear points of contact, structured coordination, and predictable governance throughout the testing period. Its objective is to ensure that participants receive timely support, that issues and questions are addressed efficiently, and that testing progresses in a controlled and transparent manner.

### 6.1 Support structure

Testing activities are supported through a dedicated and structured support set-up. Key elements of the support structure include:

- Client test documentation
- Daily assistance from onboarding and support teams during the testing period
- Continuous monitoring of requests and issues to ensure timely response and follow-up

Throughout the testing period, Euronext will make dedicated expertise available to support you as needed. This support will provide a strong mix of testing and content expertise and includes test experts and test analysts responsible for coordinating and supporting test execution, and subject matter experts from Product, Business

Operations, and other relevant functions. These experts will actively support clients by clarifying test scenarios and expected outcomes, supporting analysis and resolution of issues identified during testing, and assisting clients in progressing efficiently through their testing scope.

This structure ensures consistency of information, avoids fragmentation of communication, and supports participants throughout the testing lifecycle.

## 6.2 How to access support during testing

Participants can access direct support during testing through the following dedicated contact points, depending on the impacted infrastructure or service:

- Euronext Markets: [clientsupport@euronext.com](mailto:clientsupport@euronext.com)
- Euronext Clearing: [CCP-readiness@euronext.com](mailto:CCP-readiness@euronext.com)
- Euronext Securities: [CSD.onboarding@euronext.com](mailto:CSD.onboarding@euronext.com)

These contact points serve as the primary channels for questions, issue reporting, and coordination during testing.

## 6.3 Test governance and regular meetings

Testing governance is supported through a structured meeting framework that runs throughout the testing period defined earlier in this document.

### **Test Webinar**

Euronext has already completed two market-wide webinars in 2025 with a dedicated focus on testing. Building on this, a further test webinar will be held on January 29<sup>th</sup> 2026, with the specific objective of getting the market prepared for the start of testing.

The webinar will be jointly hosted by Euronext Markets, Euronext Clearing, and Euronext Securities, ensuring a consistent, end-to-end view across the value-chain. The session will focus on explaining the overall test approach as described in this document, the structure and objectives of the test phases, the test scenarios to be executed towards each Euronext entity, and what market participants should expect in the coming months.

In addition, the webinar will outline what is expected from market participants in terms of preparation, participation, and readiness, including practical next steps following the session. The webinar is intended as the main market-wide entry point into the testing phase and a baseline for subsequent, more detailed discussions.

### **Preparatory Test Meetings**

Following the test webinar and ahead of the start of test execution in March 2026, each Euronext entity will organize a series of preparatory test meetings with the relevant stakeholder groups. These meetings are designed to support a two-way dialogue with the market after participants have had time to review the test documentation, alongside other topics when relevant. The focus will be on addressing questions and clarifications, and confirming the understanding of the test approach.

The preparatory test meetings will also be used to align expectations, discuss any identified constraints or dependencies, and ensure that all parties are operationally ready before entering full test execution mode. As

such, they represent a key readiness checkpoint and an important transition step from documentation and planning into active testing.

#### **Entity-specific test execution coordination meetings**

Each Euronext entity will organize coordination meetings with their relevant stakeholders during the test execution phase. The purpose of the meetings is to focus on service-specific questions and issues, technical or operational clarifications, and detailed follow-up on defects or testing constraints.

The indicative frequency of these meetings are:

- Euronext Markets: Monthly and upon request
- Euronext Clearing: Regular meetings, scheduled in consultation with clients and upon request/needs)
- Euronext Securities: 1 meeting per week

To support effective discussions, a summary briefing will be shared with participants one business day ahead of each meeting, framing the agenda and key topics. Furthermore, a summary report will be published after the meeting, containing an overview of the shared information and feedback on actions taken after the meeting.

## **7. Readiness sign-off**

Readiness sign-off is used to formally confirm that testing has been completed in accordance with the applicable test plan and that the participant is ready to proceed to go-live.

Sign-off requirements are only applicable to front-to-back testing (see deadline in Section 4), for which all relevant stakeholders must provide sign-off to the relevant Euronext entity. Sign-off forms will be made available by each Euronext entity, specifying the relevant details for each client typology. The forms can be found following these links:

- Euronext Markets: [Connect - Euronext Securities European Offering](#)
- Euronext Clearing: [Connect - European Offering / Choice of CSD](#)
- Euronext Securities: [European Offering Documentation](#)

Throughout the testing period, Euronext will ask *statuses* on sign-off readiness from relevant stakeholders to have a better understanding of where we are in terms of overall readiness.

Participants required to provide a sign-off are responsible for ensuring that the relevant testing has been completed in line with the applicable test plan, reviewing the defined readiness criteria, and completing and submitting the sign-off form within the requested timeframe. Completed sign-off forms serve as formal evidence of testing completion and operational readiness for the relevant service and participant role.

The go-live decision for the planned change of Place of Settlement (PSET) scheduled for September 21<sup>st</sup> 2026 will be taken based on an overall assessment of market readiness and operational stability across the ecosystem, and will therefore not be solely dependent on individual client readiness sign-off.



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